

Drainage Board Meeting June 10th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tUK0N3icxFo
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:03:54](#) The presiding officer called the June board meeting of the Drainage Board to order and led attendees in the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Whitten, Mr. Hamilton, Mr. Christie, Mr. Bottsford, Mr. Brooke, Mr. Burchett.
 - **Members Absent:** Mr. Reagan.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in the opening roll call, but led by board leadership.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:04:05](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** [00:04:30](#) The board approved the prior meeting minutes (noted on the agenda as April 8th / May 13th discussion) following a properly seconded motion and roll call vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:05:12 Table Business: Banning Engineering Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Shaver / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed keeping the Banning Engineering report tabled because Joe Miller from Banning could not attend. The open house for the culvert is postponed until the July meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Kept tabled by consensus/previous motion.
- **00:06:16 New Business: Morrison and Bethel Culvert Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Shaver.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A 2005 reconstruction at Morrison and Bethel created an open ditch and cut off field access for farmer Chris Townsend. An undersized 2-ft culvert pipe currently holds up water. A compromise was proposed where the drainage board would pay for a replacement 30-ft by 4-ft pipe (\$1,590), and Mr. Townsend (who owns an excavating business) would install it, maintain it, and sign a bridge acknowledgement form absolving the drainage board of future responsibility. Legal and liability implications of potentially land-locking land during past reconstructions were debated.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **00:15:21** Motion by Mr. Bottsford, seconded by Mr. Christie, to table the issue for one month to gather more legal and photographic information. **Approved by Roll Call Vote** (All present members voted yes).
- **00:16:00 Old Business: Ashtons Right-of-Way Reduction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Shaver.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Follow-up from the previous month regarding Ashtons reducing the right-of-way, which requires drainage board signatures on documentation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** To be signed following the conclusion of the meeting.
- **00:16:25 Approval of May Minutes & Spraying/De-brushing Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Shaver / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding the scarcity of licensed contractors capable of ditch spraying (requiring specific category licenses). Progress reports on ongoing de-brushing projects across various creeks (Campbell Creek, Isaac Lennox, Dor Welham, Donovan, Fimple, Ham Miller, McLellan, Sriram, Morrison, Ferguson) were reviewed.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **00:22:33** Motion to approve claims (including Butler Masonry) was made and seconded. **Passed 6-0** via roll call vote.
- **00:22:49 Attorney Updates: Tree Liability & Board of Finance Investment Policy**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Brooke (Attorney) & Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Attorney Brooke reported on a 2009 Indiana case establishing landowner liability for dangerous/dead trees affecting third parties, noting the drainage

board exercises control over ditch right-of-ways and carries related responsibilities.

- Discussion occurred regarding the County Board of Finance's recent favorable review/vote to amend the county investment policy so that interest from maintenance accounts is credited back to the drainage board (and Community Corrections). An upcoming Board of Finance meeting will formally approve the amendment.

- **00:31:21 Hog Creek Drainage Assessment Report**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lindsay Meyer & Erin (Lochmueller Group).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Lochmueller Group presented its draft engineering assessment for the Hog Creek watershed. The primary issue is an undersized 48-inch corrugated metal pipe (CMP) causing frequent overtopping at County Road 700 East (draining a 2.3-square-mile / ~1,500-acre watershed). The proposed project involving ditch regrading, flattening side slopes to 4:1, replacing undersized culverts with larger box culverts, and raising a short section of CR 700 carries an estimated total cost of \$1.6 million (including a 30% contingency and non-construction costs).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *Mr. Hal & Mr. Connor* (petitioning landowners) discussed historical ditch performance, water flow issues, and weir configurations.
 - *Tommy Humbert* (County Highway Superintendent) advocated for county highway collaboration to attempt more cost-effective local maintenance alternatives before committing taxpayers to a \$1.6 million reconstruction.
 - *Jaron Crabtree* (JJC Excavating) inquired about downstream effects on Hog Creek.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** **00:28:47** Following extensive debate regarding costs (~\$1,100 per acre spread over up to 5 years, requiring 60% / 883 acres of landowner agreement), the board voted to table a decision on scheduling a formal reconstruction public hearing until the next meeting. **Approved by Roll Call Vote** (**01:37:25** Motion to table passed unanimously).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:39:03 Ricky Ancer** (Resident of 500 West near McGalliard): Addressed the board regarding massive ongoing stormwater flooding in the Westlawn subdivision following heavy rains. He highlighted that commercial developments (Gil Brothers/Ag Tech building, new pole barn) funnel stormwater into the subdivision's 60-year-old storm sewer and field tile system, urging the board to demand proper commercial detention and drainage compliance.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** The board confirmed that discussions regarding the Hog Creek reconstruction and review of Lochmueller's draft report will continue at the next monthly meeting.
- **Adjournment:** 01:43:54 Meeting adjourned following a motion, second, and unanimous voice vote ("I").

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